

Nuclear energy

All matter is made of atoms. Atoms contain particles called protons and neutrons, which are held together by a nuclear force – a bit like magnetism, but much, much stronger. When these particles are divided, energy is released. We can split atoms apart in a nuclear power station, to release energy to make electricity.



Radioactive waste

The materials used in nuclear power stations are radioactive substances. These materials, including uranium, give out harmful rays. They must be disposed of carefully, as they are dangerous for the environment.



Nuclear waste is harmful.